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Meta title: Powder Room Renovations Sydney | Small-Space Specialists | Elite Touch

Meta description: Powder room renovations across Sydney — the smallest room in the home, designed for maximum impact. NSW-licensed, AS 3740 waterproofing, 1–2 week build.

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Powder Room Renovations Sydney

The smallest room in the house. Often the one your guests notice most.

A powder room is the smallest bathroom in the home. There is no shower, usually no bath but just a toilet and a basin, sometimes inside a footprint smaller than a wardrobe. That constraint is a creative challenge because powder rooms are where homeowners can sometimes be bold: statement wallpaper, dramatic tile, a sculptural basin, a piece of art that would not work anywhere else in the house.

They can be like a jewel box and they are the room your guests will spend the most uninterrupted time looking at. Or you have the freedom to build something simple and functional, we can build it any way you like.

What is a powder room?

A powder room is a small bathroom containing a toilet and a hand basin and usually nothing else. It is sometimes called a "half bath" or "guest WC". The footprint is typically 1.5–3 square metres, and it is almost always located on the ground floor near common living areas where guests can use it without entering the private parts of the home.

What a powder room is not:

- An ensuite (which sits inside a private bedroom)
- A main bathroom (which contains a shower and/or bath)
- A laundry (which contains laundry appliances and a tub)

Why powder rooms reward design ambition

The maths of a small room cuts in your favour:

- Small surface area means a single feature can carry the whole space. A bold wallpaper that would overwhelm a main bathroom is right at home in 2 square metres.
- Premium materials become affordable. A \$300/sqm tile across a small wall costs less than the same tile in a full bathroom so the splurge is realistic rather than aspirational.
- No shower means no wet-zoning to design around. The constraints that shape a full bathroom (water exposure, glass, drying surfaces) do not apply. The design has more freedom.
- Guests notice. The powder room is the one bathroom many visitors will ever see in your home, so the investment shows publicly.

What a powder room renovation includes

The scope is smaller than a full bathroom, but every element still has to be done properly:

- Strip-out of existing fixtures, joinery, and finishes
- Wet-area waterproofing to AS 3740-2021 (yes, it is still required)
- Plumbing for the WC and basin by a NSW-licensed plumber

- Electrical for lighting, exhaust fan, and any heated towel rail or mirror, by a licensed electrician to AS/NZS 3000
- Wall and floor finishes — tile, stone, wallpaper, microcement, or paint
- A new toilet suite (we recommend wall-hung or concealed-cistern for the visual lightness it gives a small room)
- A basin (wall-mounted, vessel, or pedestal — each has design consequences)
- Tapware and accessories
- Mirror, lighting, and ventilation
- Painting and finishing

Compliance is smaller in scope but not optional

A powder room is a wet area under AS 3740 because it contains a floor waste and a water-supply fixture. The waterproofing scope is narrower than a full bathroom — no shower walls or hob — but the floor still requires a compliant, certified membrane. The plumbing and electrical work is licensed work, exactly as it would be in any other wet area.

- Floor waterproofing to AS 3740-2021, certified
- Plumbing for the toilet and basin to AS/NZS 3500 with Certificate of Compliance lodged with NSW Fair Trading
- Electrical and lighting to AS/NZS 3000 Wiring Rules
- Mechanical ventilation — most Sydney powder rooms are internal and require an extraction fan

Three Sydney powder room scenarios we see often

1. The under-stair powder room in an inner-city terrace

Carved into the space beneath the staircase in a Victorian or federation terrace. Tight footprint, sloped ceiling, heritage character to respect, and ventilation routing that has to navigate the staircase above. Often the most rewarding to design — the constraints force creative answers.

2. The apartment guest powder room

Common in larger Sydney apartments. The challenges are usually strata-related — body-corporate approval for any plumbing change, common-wall constraints, and limited venting options. We handle the strata correspondence at the quote stage.

3. The family-home main-floor powder room

Standard suburban scenario — a small room off the entrance hall or near the living areas. The brief is usually a step-change in design quality from what the builder originally installed. Most family-home powder rooms get heavier use than the owners expect, so finishes need to handle real wear.

Design moves that work in small rooms

- One bold wall (tile, wallpaper, or panelling) with the rest of the room held in a quieter neutral
- Wall-hung toilet to lift the visual weight off the floor and make the room feel larger
- A vessel basin or wall-mounted basin instead of a vanity, where storage is not the priority
- Mirror as a deliberate piece that is large, framed, or shaped rather than a builder-grade rectangle
- Considered lighting: a single statement pendant, or a sconce pair flanking the mirror, rather than a downlight
- Heritage detailing (skirting, architrave, panelling) where the home suits it

- A dark colour palette — powder rooms can take saturated colour in a way larger bathrooms cannot

Typical timeline and budget

Sydney powder room renovations typically run:

- Refresh (toilet, basin, taps, paint, new mirror): 3–7 days · \$4,000–\$10,000
- Full renovation (strip-out, waterproof, new tile, new fixtures): 1–2 weeks · \$8,000–\$20,000
- Premium powder room (statement materials, custom joinery, designer fittings): 2 weeks · \$18,000–\$30,000+

Powder rooms are the room where materials punch above their weight. A \$500 basin, a \$400/sqm tile, and a \$300 pendant are within reach in a 2 sqm space because the quantities are small.

That is why the design ceiling in a powder room is often higher than in any other room of the home.

How we work, what we build to

Every Elite Touch powder room is delivered to the relevant Australian Standards:

- Wet-area waterproofing to AS 3740-2021, certified
- Plumbing to AS/NZS 3500 by a NSW-licensed plumber, Certificate of Compliance lodged with NSW Fair Trading
- Electrical to AS/NZS 3000 by a licensed electrician
- WELS-registered tapware and toilet suite
- Slip-resistant floor tiles to AS 4586 and HB 198 — yes, even in a guest WC

NSW Builder Licence: **[licence number] 475204C** · ABN: 92 679 016 721

Recent design-led work

The design principles that shape our heritage bathroom in The Rocks — bold pattern, considered fixtures, quiet detailing around heritage fabric — transfer directly to powder rooms in similar homes. Read the case study: [\[link to The Rocks case study\]](#).

Frequently asked questions

Do I need council approval to add a powder room?

Often yes, if the powder room is new (rather than a renovation of an existing one). Adding a new wet area typically requires either complying-development approval under SEPP (Exempt and Complying Development Codes) or, in some cases, a full development application — particularly in heritage conservation areas. We assess the approval pathway at the on-site quote.

Does a powder room need ventilation?

Yes. The National Construction Code Volume Two requires ventilation in wet areas, and most Sydney powder rooms are internal so cannot rely on a window. Mechanical extraction sized to the room volume per AS 1668.2 is the standard approach.

Can a powder room add value to my home?

A well-designed, well-finished powder room is one of the strongest per-dollar value adds in a Sydney home, particularly in a property that lacks a downstairs WC. It serves guests, removes the social awkwardness of guests using a bedroom-adjacent main bathroom, and adds a design moment to the public part of the house.

What is the smallest a powder room can be?

Practically, around 0.8 m wide by 1.5 m deep — enough for a basin, a WC, and a turning circle for the door. Tighter than that and the room starts to feel claustrophobic and may struggle to comply with the minimum clearances around fixtures.

Do powder rooms really need waterproofing?

Yes — under AS 3740-2021 any room with a floor waste and a water-supply fixture is a wet area, and the floor requires a compliant, certified waterproof membrane. The scope is smaller than a full bathroom (no shower walls, no hob), but the floor is non-negotiable.

Can a powder room be done in less than a week?

A refresh — same fixtures replaced like-for-like, same finishes, new paint — can be done in three to five working days. A full renovation requiring strip-out and re-waterproofing needs the membrane to cure properly before tiling, which puts the realistic minimum at around seven working days.

Get a quote

Free on-site measure and fixed-scope written quote for powder room renovations across Sydney. Call **[primary contact phone] 0411752334** or email **[domain-based email] info@elitetouchrenovations.au**